

Rcd 11/4/00 upl

Colorado Record No: _____
Colorado Rare Bird Report Documentation Form

Common Name: Eurasian Collared Dove

Scientific Name: *Streptopelia decaocto*

Numbers Seen: 2 birds together Distance: 30 feet

Light conditions: clear, sunny, 0800 in the morning. Sun in the east and bird was north of me.

Sex and Age: Adults

Location: South side of Monte Vista in an urban area.

County: Rio Grande

Date of Observation: August 11, 2000

Description of the Bird(s): I was driving to work when I glanced at a bird fanning its tail on the powerlines. Immediately I recognized that the tail pattern had a wide light gray tailband that ruled out Mourning dove. There were two birds. Both sat there perched on the wires while I observed them for at least 3 minutes. The birds were shaped like a Mourning Dove but heavier in build. About 13 inches in length. Grayish brown on upper and lower sides. Head light gray. Wings grayish with darkened primaries. Back of neck had dark collar going half way to the front of the bird's neck. Light edging on gray mantle of bird. When birds flushed, the tail opened into a uniform fan shape with a white to light gray terminal band demarcated by a darker inner color of the retrices. Central retrices lacked the banding of the outer ones.

Habitat: Telephone wires in urban environment

Behavior: Perching, flying, landing.

Vocalizations: These individuals did not sing.

Differentiation from Similar Species: Not Ringed-turtle-dove which tend to be lighter in color. Not Mourning dove due to larger heavier build and different tail pattern. Not White-winged dove due to uniform gray wings with darker primaries. Not Spotted dove due to lack of spotting on the collar. Not Zenaida Dove for these birds were not that dark.

Previous Experience with this Species: I have seen this species in numerous trips to Texas and Florida.

Others who observed this species: Wife Lisa saw one on August 21 in Monte Vista. Paul Phillips of Monte Vista reported a dove that was different than Mourning Doves in his neighborhood and later concluded they were Eurasian Collared-doves.

Significance: This observation represents a northwestward expansion from the known population in SE Colorado. Potential first record for the San Luis Valley

Was the bird Photographed? No.

Report was Made: From notes taken at the time of observation

Observer and Signature: John J. Rawinski

Date:

October 17/2000